WoW Forever: Talent Design Atlas

All nine original classes | 27 talent trees | 466 talents | October 2026 beta snapshot

A collection of our class-by-class talent design reviews, converted into one GitHub-friendly Markdown document. The central question: does a talent change how a character plays, or mostly change the numbers?

This is a subjective mechanical-interest review, not a talent power ranking or live-server verification. The descriptions and classifications reproduce our October 2026 discussion and the accompanying PDF. Beta abilities and tooltips may change, and some effects still require in-game confirmation.

Criteria

* Interesting (mechanical): Introduces a new ability, meaningful proc, interaction between abilities, tactical decision, or conditional effect.
* Numerical (efficiency): Mainly raises stats, damage, healing, range, duration, or lowers resource costs and cooldowns.

Both can be strong or useful. These categories describe the *kind* of progression they offer, not their effectiveness.

At a glance

Talents	Interesting	Numerical	Interesting share
466	202	264	43.3%

By class

Class	Interesting	Numerical	Total	Interesting %
[Mage](#mage)	27	27	54	50.0%
[Warlock](#warlock)	25	27	52	48.1%
[Warrior](#warrior)	25	27	52	48.1%
[Rogue](#rogue)	25	28	53	47.2%
[Hunter](#hunter)	22	28	50	44.0%
[Priest](#priest)	23	30	53	43.4%
[Paladin](#paladin)	20	30	50	40.0%
[Druid](#druid)	18	34	52	34.6%
[Shaman](#shaman)	17	33	50	34.0%

By talent tree

Class	Talent tree	Interesting	Numerical	Interesting %
Mage	Fire	10	7	58.8%
Warrior	Arms	10	7	58.8%
Warrior	Fury	9	8	52.9%
Mage	Frost	10	9	52.6%
Rogue	Subtlety	10	9	52.6%
Paladin	Protection	8	8	50.0%
Warlock	Destruction	8	8	50.0%
Warlock	Demonology	9	10	47.4%
Priest	Holy	8	9	47.1%
Rogue	Assassination	8	9	47.1%
Warlock	Affliction	8	9	47.1%
Hunter	Survival	8	10	44.4%

Priest | Shadow Magic | 8 | 10 | 44.4%
Hunter | Beast Mastery | 7 | 9 | 43.8%
Hunter | Marksmanship | 7 | 9 | 43.8%
Rogue | Combat | 7 | 10 | 41.2%
Druid | Feral Combat | 8 | 12 | 40.0%
Mage | Arcane | 7 | 11 | 38.9%
Priest | Discipline | 7 | 11 | 38.9%
Shaman | Enhancement | 7 | 11 | 38.9%
Druid | Balance | 6 | 10 | 37.5%
Paladin | Holy | 6 | 11 | 35.3%
Paladin | Retribution | 6 | 11 | 35.3%
Warrior | Protection | 6 | 12 | 33.3%
Shaman | Elemental | 5 | 11 | 31.2%
Shaman | Restoration | 5 | 11 | 31.2%
Druid | Restoration | 4 | 12 | 25.0%

Class reviews

Warrior

25 interesting / 27 numerical (48.1% interesting)

Arms

10 interesting / 7 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Bloodthrill [INTERESTING] Rend can trigger Overpower procs, connecting two abilities.
Improved Hamstring [INTERESTING] Adds a chance to immobilize enemies.
Improved Slam [INTERESTING] Changes Slam's interaction with auto-attacks.
Sweeping Strikes [INTERESTING] Introduces a multi-target combat option.
Mortal Strike [INTERESTING] Adds a new attack with healing reduction.
Weaponmaster [INTERESTING] Different weapon types provide distinct bonuses.
Improved Tactical Mastery [INTERESTING] Supports and rewards stance dancing.
Deep Wounds [INTERESTING] Critical strikes inflict an additional bleed.
Anger Management [INTERESTING] Changes how Rage is generated and retained.
Spearing Strike [INTERESTING] Adds a situational attack, though its effect is additional damage.
Improved Charge [NUMERICAL] Grants more starting Rage without a new interaction.
Improved Overpower [NUMERICAL] Increases critical strike chance only.
Improved Rend [NUMERICAL] Increases bleed damage only.
Improved Heroic Strike [NUMERICAL] Reduces Rage cost only.
Deflection [NUMERICAL] Flat parry chance increase.
Two-Handed Weapon Specialization [NUMERICAL] Flat two-handed weapon damage increase.
Impale [NUMERICAL] Increases critical strike damage without changing play.

Fury

9 interesting / 8 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Gore Drinker [INTERESTING] Rage-related abilities empower subsequent attacks to restore health.
Improved Berserker Rage [INTERESTING] Adds movement-impairment removal and Rage generation.
Piercing Howl [INTERESTING] Introduces an area-control ability.
Death Wish [INTERESTING] Offers offensive power, Fear immunity, and defensive risk.
Bloodthirst [INTERESTING] Introduces an attack with an additional movement-speed effect.
Blood Craze [INTERESTING] Triggers healing from dangerous incoming attacks.
Unbridled Wrath [INTERESTING] Melee attacks can generate bonus Rage.

Flurry [INTERESTING] Critical strikes trigger faster subsequent attacks.
Lingering Rage [INTERESTING] Changes Rage retention between encounters.
Enrage [NUMERICAL] A conditional proc that results only in more damage.
Dual Wield Specialization [NUMERICAL] Mainly boosts off-hand damage and Rage generation.
Booming Voice [NUMERICAL] Improves shout radius and efficiency.
Improved Intercept [NUMERICAL] Reduces cooldown only.
Improved Execute [NUMERICAL] Reduces Rage cost only.
Furious Precision [NUMERICAL] Flat off-hand hit chance increase.
Cruelty [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Raging Blows [NUMERICAL] Milestone talent reducing Cleave and Whirlwind Rage costs.

Protection

6 interesting / 12 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Shield Specialization [INTERESTING] Blocking generates Rage.
Master of Defense [INTERESTING] Dodging and parrying generate Rage with a shield equipped.
Improved Shield Bash [INTERESTING] Adds a Silence effect to Shield Bash.
Shield Slam [INTERESTING] Adds high-threat shield attack with possible magic dispel.
Concussion Blow [INTERESTING] Introduces a targeted stun.
Last Stand [INTERESTING] Introduces an emergency survival ability.
Improved Bloodrage [NUMERICAL] Increases Rage generated, without changing the ability.
Iron Will [NUMERICAL] Reduces Stun and Fear duration.
Anticipation [NUMERICAL] Flat Defense skill increase.
Improved Revenge [NUMERICAL] Increases Revenge damage only.
Improved Thunder Clap [NUMERICAL] Reduces Rage cost only.
Defiance [NUMERICAL] Flat threat increase.
Improved Disarm [NUMERICAL] Reduces cooldown only.
Improved Sunder Armor [NUMERICAL] Reduces Rage cost only.
Bastion [NUMERICAL] Adds shield-based damage without a new interaction.
Focused Rage [NUMERICAL] Generic offensive Rage cost reduction.
Improved Shield Wall [NUMERICAL] Reduces cooldown, without changing Shield Wall's effect.
Vanguard [NUMERICAL] Permits Charge in Defensive Stance, but adds little tactical depth.

Rogue

25 interesting / 28 numerical (47.2% interesting)

Assassination

8 interesting / 9 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Mutilate [INTERESTING] New two-Combo-Point attack interacting with Poisons.
Seal Fate [INTERESTING] Critical strikes can grant extra Combo Points.
Ruthlessness [INTERESTING] Finishing moves can grant a Combo Point.
Relentless Strikes [INTERESTING] Finishing moves can restore Energy.
Cold Blood [INTERESTING] Active ability setting up a deliberate guaranteed critical strike.
Venom [INTERESTING] New Poison-focused finishing move and maintenance decision.
Improved Expose Armor [INTERESTING] Returns Combo Points on a five-point use.
Remorseless Attacks [INTERESTING] Defeating an enemy creates a critical-strike opportunity.
Improved Gouge [NUMERICAL] Increases duration only.
Malice [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Murder [NUMERICAL] Flat damage against particular creature types.
Improved Slice and Dice [NUMERICAL] Extends duration only.
Lethality [NUMERICAL] Increases critical strike damage.
Vile Poisons [NUMERICAL] Boosts Poison damage and dispel resistance.

Improved Poisons [NUMERICAL] Improves application chance and charge efficiency.
Vigor [NUMERICAL] Increases maximum Energy only.
Improved Kidney Shot [NUMERICAL] Additional damage against stunned targets; no new mechanic.

Combat

7 interesting / 10 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Riposte [INTERESTING] Parrying enables a special disarming attack.
Blade Flurry [INTERESTING] Melee attacks can hit a second target.
Improved Kick [INTERESTING] Adds Silence to Kick.
Improved Sprint [INTERESTING] Lets Sprint remove movement impairments.
Puncturing Wounds [INTERESTING] Backstab can generate an extra Combo Point.
Hack and Slash [INTERESTING] Weapon categories gain different effects, including extra attacks.
Adrenaline Rush [INTERESTING] Active Energy-regeneration burst changes combat pacing.
Improved Eviscerate [NUMERICAL] Flat damage increase.
Improved Sinister Strike [NUMERICAL] Energy cost reduction only.
Lightning Reflexes [NUMERICAL] Flat Dodge chance increase.
Deflection [NUMERICAL] Flat Parry chance increase.
Precision [NUMERICAL] Flat hit chance increase.
Endurance [NUMERICAL] Sprint and Evasion cooldown reductions.
Flawless Execution [NUMERICAL] Milestone talent reducing Eviscerate Energy cost.
Dual Wield Specialization [NUMERICAL] Flat off-hand damage increase.
Weapon Expertise [NUMERICAL] Reduces enemy Dodge and Parry against your attacks.
Aggression [NUMERICAL] Flat damage boosts to several abilities.

Subtlety

10 interesting / 9 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Cutthroat [INTERESTING] Backstab can allow Ambush without Stealth.
Hemorrhage [INTERESTING] New attack interacting with Rupture.
Setup [INTERESTING] Dodging or resisting attacks can generate Combo Points.
Initiative [INTERESTING] Stealth openers can create extra Combo Points.
Ghostly Strike [INTERESTING] New attack that temporarily improves Dodge.
Improved Distract [INTERESTING] Distract gains an additional Stealth-related effect.
Premeditation [INTERESTING] Grants Combo Points before opening.
Dirty Deeds [INTERESTING] Allows Garrote from the front, changing its use.
Preparation [INTERESTING] Resets other cooldowns for tactical combinations.
Thousand Cuts [INTERESTING] Rupture ticks reduce the cost of other attacks.
Camouflage [NUMERICAL] Faster Stealth movement and shorter cooldown.
Master of Deception [NUMERICAL] Passive Stealth-detection avoidance.
Opportunity [NUMERICAL] Flat damage increase.
Elusiveness [NUMERICAL] Reduces Vanish and Blind cooldowns.
Dirty Tricks [NUMERICAL] Reduces Sap and Blind Energy costs.
Improved Ambush [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Heightened Senses [NUMERICAL] Improves detection and avoidance statistics.
Serrated Blades [NUMERICAL] Armor penetration and Rupture damage increases.
Quietus [NUMERICAL] More damage against targets below 35% health.

Warlock

25 interesting / 27 numerical (48.1% interesting)

Affliction

8 interesting / 9 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Nightfall [INTERESTING] DoTs can enable an instant Shadow Bolt.
Wrack [INTERESTING] New channeled spell interacting with Shadow DoTs.
Soul Harvest [INTERESTING] Targets dying under Drain Soul enable Mana recovery.
Soul Siphon [INTERESTING] Rewards combining multiple Affliction effects before drains.
Improved Corruption [INTERESTING] Makes Corruption instant at maximum rank.
Amplify Curse [INTERESTING] Active ability that empowers a selected Curse or Bane.
Curse of Exhaustion [INTERESTING] Adds a new movement-control option.
Siphon Life [INTERESTING] New DoT that restores health.
Improved Life Tap [NUMERICAL] Restores more Mana only.
Suppression [NUMERICAL] Hit chance and threat adjustments.
Malediction [NUMERICAL] Flat periodic damage increase.
Improved Drains [NUMERICAL] Boosts damage and healing values.
Improved Bane of Agony [NUMERICAL] Increases damage only.
Fel Concentration [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting interruption.
Pandemic [NUMERICAL] Improves critical damage values.
Malevolence [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Shadow Mastery [NUMERICAL] Flat Shadow damage and drain increase.

Demonology

9 interesting / 10 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Demonic Pact [INTERESTING] Preserves a sacrificed demon's benefit alongside another demon.
Demonic Brand [INTERESTING] Marks targets so demon attacks trigger extra effects.
Demonic Energies [INTERESTING] Spell damage heals pet; Life Tap also restores pet Mana.
Decimation [INTERESTING] Low-health targets enable faster shard-free Soul Fires.
Soul Link [INTERESTING] Redirects incoming damage to the demon.
Demonic Sacrifice [INTERESTING] Sacrificing different demons creates distinct choices.
Master Demonologist [INTERESTING] Different demons supply distinct benefits.
Fel Domination [INTERESTING] Active ability for rapid emergency demon summoning.
Improved Health Funnel [INTERESTING] Removes a constraint on when Health Funnel can be used.
Improved Imp [NUMERICAL] Makes existing Imp abilities stronger.
Demonic Embrace [NUMERICAL] Flat Stamina increase.
Unholy Power [NUMERICAL] Flat pet damage increase.
Demonic Aegis [NUMERICAL] Improves Demon Skin / Demon Armor numbers.
Improved Voidwalker [NUMERICAL] Stronger existing Voidwalker abilities.
Fel Vitality [NUMERICAL] More Health and Mana.
Improved Sayaad [NUMERICAL] Existing pet effect and duration increases.
Master Summoner [NUMERICAL] Lower summoning time and Mana cost.
Improved Felhunter [NUMERICAL] Stronger pet effects and shorter Spell Lock cooldown.
Demonic Knowledge [NUMERICAL] Grants additional spell damage.

Destruction

8 interesting / 8 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Shadow and Flame [INTERESTING] Fire and Shadow spells empower each other.
Bane of Havoc [INTERESTING] Damage dealt elsewhere also affects a marked target.
Conflagrate [INTERESTING] New instant attack interacting with Immolate.
Aftermath [INTERESTING] Adds slowing to Conflagrate.
Pyroclasm [INTERESTING] Fire abilities can Stun enemies.
Shadowburn [INTERESTING] New instant attack with Soul Shard recovery.
Improved Shadow Bolt [INTERESTING] Critical Shadow Bolts apply a Shadow vulnerability.
Incinerate [INTERESTING] New Fire spell empowered by Immolate.
Destructive Reach [NUMERICAL] Increases spell range only.

Bane [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting times.
Molten Skin [NUMERICAL] Flat damage reduction.
Cataclysm [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Ruin [NUMERICAL] Increases critical strike damage.
Intensity [NUMERICAL] Improves pushback resistance.
Agonizing Flames [NUMERICAL] Increases critical chance and damage.
Fire and Brimstone [NUMERICAL] Only increases Conflagrate critical chance.

Mage

27 interesting / 27 numerical (50.0% interesting)

Arcane

7 interesting / 11 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Arcane Blast [INTERESTING] New spell building a bonus for subsequent spells.
Missile Barrage [INTERESTING] Other spells enable faster, free Arcane Missiles.
Presence of Mind [INTERESTING] Makes a chosen eligible spell instant.
Improved Counterspell [INTERESTING] Adds Silence to Counterspell.
Arcane Concentration [INTERESTING] Spell damage can trigger Clearcasting.
Magic Absorption [INTERESTING] Fully resisting spells restores Mana.
Arcane Power [INTERESTING] Active burst ability with Mana-consumption tradeoff.
Wand Specialization [NUMERICAL] Flat Wand damage increase.
Arcane Focus [NUMERICAL] Flat spell hit chance increase.
Improved Channeling [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting interruption.
Arcane Subtlety [NUMERICAL] Numerical resistance / threat adjustments.
Arcane Resilience [NUMERICAL] Converts Intellect into Armor.
Arcane Geometry [NUMERICAL] Flat casting range increase.
Arcane Impact [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Arcane Shielding [NUMERICAL] Improves shield efficiency and resistance.
Arcane Meditation [NUMERICAL] Passive Mana regeneration boost.
Arcane Mind [NUMERICAL] Increases Intellect and critical damage.
Arcane Instability [NUMERICAL] Flat damage and critical strike increases.

Fire

10 interesting / 7 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Heating Up [INTERESTING] Fire critical strikes accelerate the next Pyroblast.
Impact [INTERESTING] Fire spells can Stun enemies.
Improved Fire Ward [INTERESTING] Fire Ward can reflect Fire spells.
Wake of Fire [INTERESTING] Defeating enemies empowers the next Fire Blast.
Ignite [INTERESTING] Critical strikes apply a burning DoT.
Improved Scorch [INTERESTING] Scorch maintains stacking Fire vulnerability.
Pyroblast [INTERESTING] New powerful Fire spell and burn.
Blast Wave [INTERESTING] New area attack that slows enemies.
Master of Elements [INTERESTING] Critical strikes restore Mana.
Combustion [INTERESTING] Timed active effect building critical chance until three crits.
Incineration [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance boosts.
Improved Fireball [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting time.
Flame Throwing [NUMERICAL] Increases spell range.
Burning Soul [NUMERICAL] Casting protection and threat adjustments.
Improved Flamestrike [NUMERICAL] Increases critical strike chance.
Critical Mass [NUMERICAL] Flat Fire critical chance increase.
Fire Power [NUMERICAL] Flat Fire damage increase.

Frost

10 interesting / 9 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Fingers of Frost [INTERESTING] Chill effects allow spells to treat targets as Frozen.
Frostbite [INTERESTING] Chill effects can Freeze targets.
Ice Lance [INTERESTING] New instant spell synergizing with Frozen targets.
Improved Blizzard [INTERESTING] Adds a slowing effect to Blizzard.
Frost Warding [INTERESTING] Frost Ward can reflect Frost spells.
Shatter [INTERESTING] Rewards attacking Frozen enemies.
Cold Snap [INTERESTING] Resets Frost cooldowns for tactical combinations.
Ice Block [INTERESTING] Defensive immunity with inability to act.
Winter's Chill [INTERESTING] Stacking debuff supporting Frostbolt / Ice Lance.
Ice Barrier [INTERESTING] New shield that prevents casting interruption.
Improved Frostbolt [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting time.
Elemental Precision [NUMERICAL] Flat spell hit chance increase.
Ice Shards [NUMERICAL] Increases critical strike damage.
Permafrost [NUMERICAL] Improves strength and duration of slows.
Improved Frost Nova [NUMERICAL] Cooldown reduction only.
Piercing Ice [NUMERICAL] Flat Frost damage increase.
Frost Channeling [NUMERICAL] Mana cost and threat reduction.
Arctic Reach [NUMERICAL] Increases range and radius.
Improved Cone of Cold [NUMERICAL] Increases damage only.

Hunter

22 interesting / 28 numerical (44.0% interesting)

Beast Mastery

7 interesting / 9 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Deadly Aspects [INTERESTING] Auto-attacks can trigger Aspect-dependent attack speed.
Improved Aspect of the Monkey [INTERESTING] Shares a defensive Aspect effect with the pet.
Improved Mend Pet [INTERESTING] Mend Pet can cleanse harmful effects.
Summon Hawk [INTERESTING] Adds an attacking hawk summon.
Intimidation [INTERESTING] Pet can Stun an enemy.
Frenzy [INTERESTING] Pet critical strikes increase attack speed.
Bestial Wrath [INTERESTING] Active pet empowerment with control protection.
Endurance Training [NUMERICAL] Flat pet Health and Armor increase.
Focused Fire [NUMERICAL] Flat damage while a pet is active.
Pathfinding [NUMERICAL] Increases existing speed bonuses.
Improved Revive Pet [NUMERICAL] Faster, cheaper pet resurrection.
Bestial Swiftness [NUMERICAL] Flat pet speed increase.
Unleashed Fury [NUMERICAL] Flat pet and hawk damage increase.
Ferocity [NUMERICAL] Flat pet critical strike chance increase.
Spirit Bond [NUMERICAL] Passive Health regeneration.
Bestial Discipline [NUMERICAL] Pet Focus and Hunter Mana regeneration numbers.

Marksmanship

7 interesting / 9 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Improved Concussive Shot [INTERESTING] Adds a chance to Stun the target.
Rapid Killing [INTERESTING] Defeating enemies empowers the next Shot.

Lone Wolf [INTERESTING] Rewards fighting without a pet, changing playstyle.
Trueshot Aura [INTERESTING] Introduces a party-support aura.
Rapid Recuperation [INTERESTING] Connects Serpent Sting / Rapid Killing to Mana return.
Scatter Shot [INTERESTING] New ranged crowd-control ability.
Sniper Shot [INTERESTING] Long-range attack that extends subsequent Shot range.
Hawk Eye [NUMERICAL] Flat ranged attack range increase.
Lethal Attacks [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Improved Stings [NUMERICAL] Existing Sting damage / cooldown / duration changes.
Efficiency [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Careful Aim [NUMERICAL] Converts Intellect into Attack Power.
Improved Arcane Shot [NUMERICAL] Reduces Arcane Shot cooldown.
Mortal Shots [NUMERICAL] Increases critical strike damage.
Barrage [NUMERICAL] Flat damage increase for multiple shots.
Ranged Weapon Specialization [NUMERICAL] Flat ranged damage increase.

Survival

8 interesting / 10 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Entrapment [INTERESTING] Traps can immobilize enemies.
Improved Wing Clip [INTERESTING] Wing Clip can immobilize the target.
Deterrence [INTERESTING] New defensive ability.
Counterattack [INTERESTING] Parrying enables an immobilizing counterattack.
Resourcefulness [INTERESTING] Critical strikes can trigger Mana regeneration while casting.
Expose Prey [INTERESTING] Hunter's Mark can enable Mongoose Bite.
Strider Kick [INTERESTING] New melee attack with movement-speed effect.
Lacerating Strikes [INTERESTING] Mongoose Bite also applies a bleed.
Improved Tracking [NUMERICAL] Extra damage against tracked creature types.
Deflection [NUMERICAL] Flat Parry chance increase.
Savage Strikes [NUMERICAL] Flat melee critical chance increase.
Survivalist [NUMERICAL] Flat Health increase.
Clever Traps [NUMERICAL] Longer control and more trap damage.
Surefooted [NUMERICAL] Hit chance and movement impairment bonuses.
Survival Tactics [NUMERICAL] Better Trap and Feign Death success rates.
Predator's Edge [NUMERICAL] Critical and off-hand damage increases.
Survivalist's Discipline [NUMERICAL] Cooldown reductions only.
Lightning Reflexes [NUMERICAL] Flat Agility increase.

Shaman

17 interesting / 33 numerical (34.0% interesting)

Elemental

5 interesting / 11 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Lava Burst [INTERESTING] New spell that rewards Flame Shock maintenance.
Lightning Overload [INTERESTING] Lightning spells can trigger a free second cast.
Earthbound [INTERESTING] Earthbind Totem can immobilize enemies.
Elemental Focus [INTERESTING] Offensive spells can trigger a free spell.
Elemental Devastation [INTERESTING] Spell critical strikes empower melee critical chance.
Convection [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Concussion [NUMERICAL] Flat damage increase.
Elemental Warding [NUMERICAL] Passive damage reduction.
Reverberation [NUMERICAL] Shock cooldown reduction.
Call of Flame [NUMERICAL] Fire damage increase.

Elemental Alacrity [NUMERICAL] Casting time reduction.
Improved Fire Nova [NUMERICAL] More damage and shorter cooldown.
Eye of the Storm [NUMERICAL] Spellcasting pushback reduction.
Call of Thunder [NUMERICAL] Critical strike chance increase.
Elemental Reach [NUMERICAL] Spell range increase.
Elemental Fury [NUMERICAL] Critical strike damage increase.

Enhancement

7 interesting / 11 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Maelstrom Weapon [INTERESTING] Melee builds stacks powering Lightning Bolt casting.
Improved Stormstrike [INTERESTING] Dodge/parry may reset Stormstrike; also restores Mana.
Stormstrike [INTERESTING] New melee attack empowering Lightning and Earth Shock effects.
Improved Ghost Wolf [INTERESTING] Ghost Wolf indoors and eventually instant.
Spirit Weapons [INTERESTING] Rockbiter changes threat behavior and combat role.
Flurry [INTERESTING] Melee critical strikes trigger haste.
Rage of the Farseer [INTERESTING] New active attack-speed window; effect mainly numerical.
Earth's Grasp [NUMERICAL] Totem health and radius increases.
Thundering Strikes [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Ancestral Knowledge [NUMERICAL] Flat Intellect increase.
Guardian Totems [NUMERICAL] Stronger defensive totems and shorter cooldown.
Mental Dexterity [NUMERICAL] Converts Intellect into Attack Power.
Improved Lightning Shield [NUMERICAL] Increases damage only.
Elemental Weapons [NUMERICAL] Boosts weapon enchantment numbers.
Shamanistic Focus [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reductions.
Anticipation [NUMERICAL] Flat Dodge chance increase.
Toughness [NUMERICAL] Flat Stamina increase.
Mental Quickness [NUMERICAL] Converts Intellect into spell power.

Restoration

5 interesting / 11 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Riptide [INTERESTING] Instant healing HoT empowers Chain Heal on target.
Water Shield [INTERESTING] Damage and critical healing trigger Mana restoration.
Nature's Swiftness [INTERESTING] Makes an eligible Nature spell instant.
Mana Tide Totem [INTERESTING] New active group Mana recovery ability.
Ancestral Healing [INTERESTING] Critical heals add an Armor buff.
Improved Healing Wave [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting time.
Totemic Focus [NUMERICAL] Reduces Totem Mana costs.
Mindfulness [NUMERICAL] Passive Mana regen while casting.
Natural Grace [NUMERICAL] Flat threat reduction.
Tidal Focus [NUMERICAL] Mana cost and hit chance adjustments.
Improved Reincarnation [NUMERICAL] Cooldown / resource value improvements.
Healing Focus [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting interruption.
Tidal Mastery [NUMERICAL] Increases healing crit chance.
Restorative Totems [NUMERICAL] Improves existing totem numbers.
Healing Way [NUMERICAL] Flat Healing Wave effectiveness boost.
Purification [NUMERICAL] Flat healing increase.

Priest

23 interesting / 30 numerical (43.4% interesting)

Discipline

7 interesting / 11 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Penance [INTERESTING] New channeled ability that heals or damages.
Divine Aegis [INTERESTING] Critical heals create protective shields.
Renewed Hope [INTERESTING] Healing Weakened Soul targets reduces its duration.
Inner Focus [INTERESTING] Active buff empowering the next spell.
Power Infusion [INTERESTING] Active tactical buff applied to an ally.
Martyrdom [INTERESTING] Receiving a crit triggers pushback protection.
Power in Light [INTERESTING] Holy Fire empowers Smite and Penance.
Wand Specialization [NUMERICAL] Flat Wand damage increase.
Twin Disciplines [NUMERICAL] Flat damage and healing increase.
Silent Resolve [NUMERICAL] Threat and crowd-control duration adjustments.
Holy Precision [NUMERICAL] Flat Holy spell hit chance increase.
Improved Power Word: Shield [NUMERICAL] Increases absorption only.
Mental Agility [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Meditation [NUMERICAL] Passive Mana regeneration.
Improved Inner Fire [NUMERICAL] More Armor and charges.
Mental Strength [NUMERICAL] Flat Intellect increase.
Soul Warding [NUMERICAL] Shield cooldown and Mana cost reductions.
Improved Mana Burn [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting time.

Holy

8 interesting / 9 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Prayer of Mending [INTERESTING] Healing effect jumps between allies.
Litany of Light [INTERESTING] Rewards alternating different healing spells.
Binding Heal [INTERESTING] Heals another player and caster together.
Spirit of Redemption [INTERESTING] Allows temporary free healing after death.
Searing Light [INTERESTING] Holy Fire ticks can make Holy Nova free.
Holy Nova [INTERESTING] New area attack and healing ability.
Blessed Recovery [INTERESTING] Large incoming hits trigger self-healing.
Inspiration [INTERESTING] Critical heals grant target an Armor bonus.
Twilight Focus [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting interruption.
Improved Renew [NUMERICAL] Flat healing increase.
Holy Specialization [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Spell Warding [NUMERICAL] Passive magic damage reduction.
Divine Fury [NUMERICAL] Casting time reduction.
Holy Reach [NUMERICAL] Range and radius increases.
Improved Healing [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Spiritual Guidance [NUMERICAL] Spirit converts into healing and damage.
Spiritual Healing [NUMERICAL] Flat healing increase.

Shadow Magic

8 interesting / 10 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Devouring Contagion [INTERESTING] Devouring Plague can spread when target dies.
Blackout [INTERESTING] Shadow damage can Stun enemies.
Mind Flay [INTERESTING] New channeled slowing attack.
Improved Mind Flay [INTERESTING] Changes tradeoff between slow, damage and range.
Vampiric Embrace [INTERESTING] Shadow damage produces party healing.
Silence [INTERESTING] Adds targeted caster control.
Spirit Tap [INTERESTING] Killing enemies triggers stronger regeneration.

Shadowform [INTERESTING] New combat form with healing restrictions.
Shadow Focus [NUMERICAL] Flat spell hit increase.
Shadow Affinity [NUMERICAL] Threat reduction.
Improved Shadow Word: Pain [NUMERICAL] Extends duration only.
Shadow Reach [NUMERICAL] Increases spell range.
Improved Mind Blast [NUMERICAL] Cooldown reduction only.
Improved Psychic Scream [NUMERICAL] Cooldown reduction only.
Improved Fade [NUMERICAL] Cooldown reduction only.
Shadow Weaving [NUMERICAL] Stacking Shadow damage bonuses, little spell-choice change.
Early Demise [NUMERICAL] More critical chance against weakened enemies.
Darkness [NUMERICAL] Flat Shadow damage increase.

Druid

18 interesting / 34 numerical (34.6% interesting)

Balance

6 interesting / 10 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Eclipse [INTERESTING] Wrath empowers subsequent Starfire casts.
Moonkin Form [INTERESTING] New form with distinct bonuses and restrictions.
Overgrowth [INTERESTING] Roots can affect additional targets.
Nature's Grace [INTERESTING] Spell crits trigger faster casting.
Improved Starfire [INTERESTING] Starfire can Stun enemies.
Insect Swarm [INTERESTING] New DoT with defensive debuff.
Improved Wrath [NUMERICAL] Cast time and Mana cost reduction.
Genesis [NUMERICAL] Periodic damage and healing increases.
Moonglow [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Improved Moonfire [NUMERICAL] Damage and critical chance increases.
Nature's Majesty [NUMERICAL] Flat critical chance increase.
Nature's Reach [NUMERICAL] Increases spell range / hit chance.
Improved Entangling Roots [NUMERICAL] Increases damage and break threshold.
Nature's Splendor [NUMERICAL] Extends spell durations.
Vengeance [NUMERICAL] Increases critical strike damage.
Moonfury [NUMERICAL] Flat Arcane / Nature damage increase.

Feral Combat

8 interesting / 12 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Berserk [INTERESTING] Changes Primal Bite into multi-target attack with no cooldown.
Shifting Power [INTERESTING] Active Mana-to-Energy resource conversion.
Feral Charge [INTERESTING] New gap-closing and interruption ability.
Primal Bite [INTERESTING] New high-threat Bear attack.
Blood Frenzy [INTERESTING] Crits generate Rage in Bear or Combo Points in Cat.
Natural Reaction [INTERESTING] Dodging attacks generates Rage.
Leader of the Pack [INTERESTING] Party-wide critical chance aura tied to forms.
Rend and Tear [INTERESTING] Rewards attacking bleeding targets, albeit with damage.
Ferocity [NUMERICAL] Rage and Energy cost reduction.
Heart of the Wild [NUMERICAL] Flat form-dependent attributes.
Feral Swiftness [NUMERICAL] Movement speed and Dodge bonuses.
Feral Instinct [NUMERICAL] Swipe damage and detection improvements.
Brutal Impact [NUMERICAL] Stun duration and Bash cooldown adjustments.
Thick Hide [NUMERICAL] Flat Armor / Defense boost.
Shredding Attacks [NUMERICAL] Energy and Rage cost reductions.

Savage Fury [NUMERICAL] Flat damage increases.
Sharpened Claws [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Predatory Strikes [NUMERICAL] Flat Attack Power scaling.
Improved Shifting Power [NUMERICAL] Cooldown reduction only.
Natural Instinct [NUMERICAL] Critical damage and healing value increases.

Restoration

4 interesting / 12 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Swiftmend [INTERESTING] Consumes or uses HoTs for instant healing.
Wild Growth [INTERESTING] New distinctive group-healing spell.
Nature's Swiftness [INTERESTING] Makes an eligible Nature spell instant.
Furor [INTERESTING] Changes Rage and Energy upon shapeshifting.
Nature's Focus [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting interruption.
Naturalist [NUMERICAL] Cast time reduction and flat damage increase.
Subtlety [NUMERICAL] Flat threat reduction.
Natural Shapeshifter [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Reflection [NUMERICAL] More Mana regeneration while casting.
Gift of Nature [NUMERICAL] Flat healing increase.
Gift of the Earthmother [NUMERICAL] Reduces global cooldown of healing spells.
Tranquil Spirit [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Improved Rejuvenation [NUMERICAL] Flat healing increase.
Living Spirit [NUMERICAL] Flat Spirit increase.
Improved Tranquility [NUMERICAL] Cooldown and threat reduction.
Improved Regrowth [NUMERICAL] Flat critical healing chance increase.

Paladin

20 interesting / 30 numerical (40.0% interesting)

Holy

6 interesting / 11 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Light's Vigil [INTERESTING] Holy Shock interacts with a marked target.
Infusion of Light [INTERESTING] Critical Holy effects speed subsequent Holy Light.
Voice of Truth [INTERESTING] Active anti-Silence and Interrupt effect.
Divine Favor [INTERESTING] Active guaranteed critical heal / Holy Shock.
Holy Shock [INTERESTING] New instant offensive or healing ability.
Illumination [INTERESTING] Critical heals restore Mana.
Divine Strength [NUMERICAL] Flat Strength increase.
Divine Intellect [NUMERICAL] Flat Intellect increase.
Healing Light [NUMERICAL] Flat healing increase.
Spiritual Focus [NUMERICAL] Reduces casting interruption.
Improved Seals [NUMERICAL] Flat Seal and Judgement damage increases.
Unyielding Faith [NUMERICAL] Fear and Disorient duration reduction.
Reverence [NUMERICAL] Mana regeneration while casting.
Purifying Power [NUMERICAL] Mana costs and cooldowns reduced.
Divine Precision [NUMERICAL] Flat Holy spell hit chance.
Consecrated Ground [NUMERICAL] Damage boost against enemies in Consecration.
Holy Power [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.

Protection

8 interesting / 8 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Holy Shield [INTERESTING] Blocking damages enemies and generates threat.
Reckoning [INTERESTING] Blocks or incoming crits can trigger additional attacks.
Shield Specialization [INTERESTING] Successful blocks restore Mana.
Improved Seal of Fury [INTERESTING] Breaking a protective shield restores Mana.
Iron Creed [INTERESTING] Holy Strike reduces incoming damage with Righteous Fury.
Swift Judgement [INTERESTING] Resets Judgement and makes the next use free.
Templar's Bulwark [INTERESTING] New defensive absorb-shield cooldown.
Redoubt [INTERESTING] Incoming hits can trigger higher block chance and synergies.
Toughness [NUMERICAL] Flat Armor increase.
Precision [NUMERICAL] Flat hit chance increase.
Guardian's Favor [NUMERICAL] Cooldown and duration adjustments.
Anticipation [NUMERICAL] Flat Defense skill increase.
Improved Righteous Fury [NUMERICAL] Passive damage reduction.
Sacred Duty [NUMERICAL] Additional Stamina and shorter cooldowns.
One-Handed Weapon Specialization [NUMERICAL] Flat weapon damage increase.
Improved Hammer of Justice [NUMERICAL] Reduces cooldown only.

Retribution

6 interesting / 11 numerical

Talent | Rating | Why
Twist of Light [INTERESTING] Switching Seals retains an echo of the previous Seal.
Sacred Arbiter [INTERESTING] Holy Strike refreshes Judgements.
Seal of Command [INTERESTING] New Seal with extra attacks and stun synergy.
Repentance [INTERESTING] New crowd-control ability.
Eye for an Eye [INTERESTING] Incoming crits trigger retaliatory damage.
Vindication [INTERESTING] Weakens enemy Attack Power while empowering yours.
Deflection [NUMERICAL] Flat Parry chance increase.
Benediction [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reduction.
Improved Judgement [NUMERICAL] Cooldown reduction only.
Holy Conduit [NUMERICAL] Mana cost reductions.
Conviction [NUMERICAL] Flat critical strike chance increase.
Sanctified Judgement [NUMERICAL] Mana refund; mainly an efficiency effect.
Pursuit of Justice [NUMERICAL] Flat movement speed increase.
Two-Handed Weapon Specialization [NUMERICAL] Flat weapon damage increase.
Vengeance [NUMERICAL] Critical strikes trigger a stacking damage buff only.
Champion of the Light [NUMERICAL] Converts Intellect into spell damage.
Instrument of Law [NUMERICAL] Cast-speed and threat numerical adjustments.

Illustrative redesign ideas

These are ideas from our conversation, not final or balance-tested talent tooltips. They suggest how a numerical talent might gain another interaction, effect, or tactical use.

Warrior

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement
Vanguard | Make Charge usable during combat, or make it trigger Revenge when used in Defensive Stance.
Improved Sunder Armor | Each stack could also reduce target Defense by 1, up to 5.
Improved Disarm | Suppress weapon attribute bonuses for the duration.
Improved Thunder Clap | Add threat, targets, or a secondary control effect instead of only saving Rage.
Improved Heroic Strike | Give Heroic Strike a chance to refresh Rend.

Rogue

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement
Flawless Execution | Reward a finishing-move combination instead of merely lowering Eviscerate Energy cost.
Improved Sinister Strike | Let it interact with another Combat ability.
Improved Eviscerate | Add a conditional effect rather than only bonus damage.
Quietus | Grant an additional effect against weakened targets.
Vigor | Tie extra Energy capacity to a distinct technique or action.

Warlock

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement
Fire and Brimstone | Let Conflagrate spread Immolate to another enemy.
Improved Bane of Agony | Add a secondary proc from periodic damage.
Improved Voidwalker | Let the Voidwalker intervene when its master is attacked.
Improved Felhunter | Reward successful Spell Lock interruptions.
Demonic Aegis | Trigger an interaction when magical damage is taken.

Mage

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement
Improved Cone of Cold | Let Cone of Cold empower the next Ice Lance.
Arcane Impact | Allow Arcane crits to empower Arcane Missiles.
Improved Flamestrike | Add an effect involving targets standing in its burning area.
Arcane Resilience | Have physical damage sometimes enhance Mana Shield.
Improved Frost Nova | Add a defensive effect or bonus against rooted targets.

Hunter

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement
Improved Arcane Shot | Arcane Shot could empower the next Serpent Sting.
Improved Stings | Allow Stings to empower another Shot or punish enemy attacks.
Focused Fire | Let Hunter critical strikes empower the pet.
Barrage | Make Multi-Shot interact with Hunter's Mark.
Survivalist's Discipline | Reward a successful trap with a temporary combat benefit.

Shaman

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement
Improved Lightning Shield | Shield discharge could empower Earth Shock.
Improved Fire Nova | Introduce interaction with targets affected by Flame Shock.
Healing Way | Healing Wave could strengthen a subsequent healing spell.
Guardian Totems | A Grounding Totem spell absorption could trigger another defense.
Rage of the Farseer | Let melee attacks empower the next offensive spell.

Priest

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement
Improved Shadow Word: Pain | Mind Flay could refresh the DoT.
Improved Power Word: Shield | Shield expiration could grant a small heal.
Improved Mind Blast | Add interaction with Shadow Word: Pain.
Improved Renew | Renew could empower the next direct heal.
Soul Warding | Absorbed damage could trigger a secondary benefit.

Druid

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement

Improved Moonfire | Moonfire DoT ticks could empower Wrath.
Improved Shifting Power | Activating it could empower the next Combo Point builder.
Improved Rejuvenation | Healing Touch could refresh Rejuvenation.
Improved Tranquility | Add a protective effect to allies healed.
Gift of the Earthmother | Combining HoTs could trigger an extra healing or defensive effect.

Paladin

Talent | Possible mechanical improvement
Improved Hammer of Justice | Add a secondary suppression effect during the stun.
Improved Seals | Give different Seals a new effect when judged.
Consecrated Ground | Slow enemies standing in Consecration.
Improved Righteous Fury | Holy Strike could trigger a protective effect.
Holy Conduit | Exorcism or Holy Wrath could empower Holy Strike.

Design principle

Not necessarily more powerful talents. More talents that give players new things to do. Interactions, decisions, combat reactions, and moments of discovery can make spending a talent point feel like learning something. Numerical improvements still have a place, but shouldn't be the only form of character development.